SOP: Weekly Blog Post Publishing (Lumen & Pine Candle Co.)

2026-10-19

This SOP shows how a virtual assistant publishes the weekly blog post for Lumen & Pine Candle Co., a fictional online shop for hand-poured soy candles led by CEO Olivia Hartwell.

Process Name	Last Updated	Owner	Frequency	Next Review
Weekly Blog Post Publishing	2026-10-19	Jesyka, Virtual Assistant	Weekly (every Monday)	2027-01-19

1. Quick Start (Video Walkthrough)

Watch the 4-minute screen recording first if you learn best by seeing the process done.

Video	Details
Link	loom.com/share/lumen-pine-weekly-blog (sample link)
Duration	4 minutes
Last recorded	2026-10-19

How to record your own SOP video

- Use Loom (free) at loom.com for quick recordings.
- Keep it under 5 minutes; 2 to 3 minutes is ideal.
- Narrate what you are doing as you do it.
- Re-record whenever the process changes.
- Add chapters or timestamps for longer videos.
- Never show passwords, API keys, or client data on screen while recording.

2. Purpose & Overview

2.1 What This Process Does

This SOP documents how to publish the weekly blog post to the Lumen & Pine WordPress site, with consistent formatting and SEO optimization.

2.2 When to Use This SOP

- **Schedule:** Every Monday by 10 AM US Eastern Time (ET).
- **Condition:** When Olivia Hartwell or the marketing lead requests an extra post, such as a seasonal candle launch.
- **Exception:** Skip the week the shop is closed for holidays; the client confirms those dates in Slack.

2.3 Expected Outcome

A fully formatted, SEO-optimized blog post is live on lumenandpine.example and shared to Instagram and Pinterest.

2.4 Time Estimate

30 to 45 minutes for an experienced assistant; 60 to 90 minutes the first time.

3. Tools & Access Required

> **Security reminder:** never put passwords in this document. Store all credentials in 1Password and link to the vault entry instead.

3.1 Software & Accounts Needed

☐ WordPress: access via the "Lumen & Pine Blog" entry in 1Password
☐ Canva Pro: access via the shared team login in 1Password
☐ ChatGPT: team account, used for outlines and meta descriptions
☐ Google Drive: shared folder "Lumen & Pine / Content Calendar"
☐ Slack: channel #blog-publishing
☐ Grammarly: free account for proofreading

3.2 Files & Resources

- Blog Post Template (Google Doc in the Content Calendar folder)
- Brand guidelines PDF (warm cream, forest green, serif headings)
- Asset folder with product photos, logos and approved lifestyle images
- Keyword list maintained by marketing lead Daniel Cruz

4. Step-by-Step Workflow

Step 1: Prepare the draft

Open the Content Calendar and find this week's approved topic and keyword. Copy the Blog Post Template into a new Google Doc named with the publish date.

- Paste the approved draft from the writer into the template.
- Check the target keyword appears in the title, first paragraph and one subheading.
- Add 2 internal links to product pages and 1 link to an older post.

> **Warning:** Always save your draft before switching tabs. WordPress does not auto-save custom blocks.

Step 2: Create the visuals

Build the featured image and one social graphic in Canva using the brand kit.

- Use the 1200 x 630 px featured image template.
- Compress both images with TinyPNG so each is under 200 KB.
- Write alt text that describes the image in one sentence.

Step 3: Format and schedule in WordPress

Paste the content into a new WordPress post and apply the site's heading styles.

- Add the featured image, category and 3 tags.
- Fill in the SEO title and meta description (under 155 characters).
- Set the post to publish Monday at 9:30 AM ET.

> **Warning:** Check the publish time zone in WordPress settings. A wrong time zone will release the post at the wrong hour.

Step 4: Final review and completion

Preview the post on desktop and mobile, then publish or confirm the schedule.

Quality check before completing

☐ Proofread all content with Grammarly
☐ Click every link and confirm it works
☐ Preview on mobile
☐ Verify all images display and have alt text
☐ Confirm the meta description and keyword are set

5. Troubleshooting Zone

If you are blocked for more than 30 minutes, escalate to Daniel Cruz in Slack.

If this happens	Then do this
Can't log into WordPress	1. Clear the browser cache. 2. Try incognito mode. 3. Reset the password from the login page. 4. Message Daniel Cruz in Slack.
Image won't upload or is too large	1. Compress it with TinyPNG. 2. Check it is JPG or PNG. 3. Try a different browser.
AI prompt gives the wrong output	1. Add more context to the prompt. 2. Rephrase it. 3. Break it into smaller requests.
Task takes longer than expected	1. Check whether you skipped a step. 2. Review the video walkthrough. 3. Ask for help before the deadline. 4. Note the blocker in the Content Calendar.
Client asks for something outside scope	1. Don't say no right away. 2. Clarify the request. 3. Check with Daniel Cruz. 4. Record it in project notes.

5.1 Who to Contact for Help

- **Technical issues:** Priya Nair (web developer), via Slack #blog-publishing
- **Process questions:** Daniel Cruz (marketing lead), via Slack direct message
- **Client-related:** Olivia Hartwell (CEO), via Slack direct message
- **Urgent or after-hours:** Olivia Hartwell, via WhatsApp

6. Definition of Done

Check every box before marking the task complete.

☐ Post is published or scheduled for Monday 9:30 AM ET
☐ Social posts are scheduled on Instagram and Pinterest
☐ Daniel Cruz is notified in #blog-publishing with the post link
☐ Content Calendar row is marked "Published"
☐ Task is marked complete in Asana
☐ Time is logged accurately

7. Version History

Date	Updated By	Changes Made
2026-10-19	Jesyka	Added escalation rule, time zone and mobile preview check
2026-09-14	Jesyka	Added Canva image size and TinyPNG compression step
2026-08-03	Jesyka	Initial version created